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Lab 6: Emergency Triage

"We didn't change anything, we swear!"

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Setting up for the lab

1. Restart the SQL Server service (clears stats)
2. Restore your StackOverflow database
3. Copy & run the Lab 6 setup script
4. If you saved your Lab 5 changes, apply those
5. Start SQLQueryStress:
 1. File Explorer, D:\Labs, run SQLQueryStress.exe
 2. Click File, Open, D:\Labs\ServerLab5.json
 3. No need to touch "Number of Threads" this time
 4. Click Go

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SQLQueryStress settings

Same as ServerLab5 – not a typo.

The screenshot shows the SQLQueryStress application window. The title bar reads "SQLQueryStress". The menu bar has "File" and "Help". The main text area contains the query: "EXEC usp_ServerLab5". To the right of the text area are buttons: "Clean Buffers", "Free Cache", "GO", and "Cancel". Below these are several sections of settings:

- Database**: A button labeled "Database".
- Parameter Substitution**: A section header.
- Number of Iterations**: A spin box set to "10000".
- Number of Threads**: A spin box set to "100".
- Delay between queries (ms)**: A spin box set to "100".
- CPU Seconds/Iteration (Avg)**: A text box, currently empty.
- Actual Seconds/Iteration (Avg)**: A text box, currently empty.
- Progress**: A section header.
- Elapsed Time**: A text box, currently empty.
- Iterations Completed**: A text box, currently empty.
- Client Seconds/Iteration (Avg)**: A text box, currently empty.
- Total Exceptions**: A text box, currently empty.
- Logical Reads/Iteration (Avg)**: A text box, currently empty.

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Things used to be fine.

Same queries & workload, but...something's wrong!

Everybody's a sysadmin, and no one's fessing up.

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How I'd budget this hour

30 minutes: server review. Run `sp_BlitzFirst` to check your wait stats, and look at what queries or indexes are causing those waits.

Sure, lots of things are bad – but are there just 1-2 changes you can make to speed lots of things up?

(Like maybe to undo something that someone did – think about being in an office where someone has access to a server, and they're doing things they don't entirely understand.)

Talk to your manager in Slack: explain what you wanna change, and why.

(Then do it, and you may need to repeat the process.)



I'll stay on Slack for the hour.

You can start working on the lab now.

I'll monitor Slack for questions.

Want to watch me do it? Go watch
the Instant Replay videos now.

Your VMs will stay on for 3 hours.
(Need longer? Email help@brentozar.com.)

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Revisiting your training

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Go to BrentOzar.com, Training.

Can't see it? Email Help@BrentOzar.com with your email address and your receipt.

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You can do this.

For questions, leave comments on the relevant module.

For private help, email Help@BrentOzar.com:

- A note that you were in this class
- `sp_Blitz @CheckServerInfo = 1`
- `sp_BlitzFirst @SinceStartup= 1`



**Thanks, and I hope you
had a great time!**



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